

SNIPPETS

Mini notebooks will rule in 2009

Shipments of mini notebooks in Asia Pacific will reach four million units in 2009, growing by 82 per cent over 2008, according to Gartner, Inc. Growth will stabilise at approximately 20 per cent in 2010 and 2011, when mini notebooks will account for more than 14 per cent of all mobile PCs shipped.

Polycom leads Indian video conferencing market

Polycom, Inc. continues to hold market dominance in video conferencing endpoints across the Asia Pacific region, according to Frost & Sullivan's recently released research report. Frost & Sullivan also recognises Polycom as the dominant video conferencing solutions provider in the Indian market and named Polycom as the best vendor (video conferencing infrastructure and endpoints) in the 2008 Frost & Sullivan India Market Leadership Awards.

Samsung hikes retail presence

Samsung India is geared to increase its retail presence in India by moving into six to seven more cities this calendar year. Presently, Samsung sells its mobile PCs only in eight major cities but with the launch of its new notebooks and netbooks, the company is planning to reach out to more customers. The company has launched four lightweight notebooks under its N series and three models under its R series of notebooks.

Asustek's 29.5cm PCs

Asustek Computer plans to launch a 29.5cm Eee PC later this month but will still consider 25.4 cm as the mainstream specification for 2009, accounting for 50 per cent of its total shipments, while 29.5cm models will account for 30 per cent, according to company president Jerry Shen.

to the latest trends in the electronics industry.

HP recalls 70,000 laptop batteries

Following two incidents in which overheated batteries caused damage to property, Hewlett Packard (HP) has announced a worldwide voluntary recall-and-replacement programme for some 70,000 battery packs used in certain HP notebook PCs.

HP and the battery cell manufacturer believe that certain battery packs shipped in HP notebook PCs manufactured between August 2007 and January 2008 may pose a potential safety hazard to customers. The batteries being recalled are made in China. The company, however, did not disclose the name of the battery manufacturer. The recalled lithium-ion batteries are from nine models of HP Pavilion, nine models of Compaq Presario, two models of HP and one model of HP Compaq.

All HP notebooks sold in US from hp.com as well as hpshopping.com (from August 2007 through March 2008 for between \$500 and \$3000) are eligible for battery pack replacement programme.

Panasonic, Sumitomo to produce 102cm OLED TVs

Panasonic and Sumitomo Chemical are reportedly teaming up to produce 102cm or larger OLED (organic light-emitting diode) TVs. The companies plan to start production in 2010 and aim to have a TV that consumes 40W by 2015. The TV will be 3mm thick and at least 20 times brighter than plasma displays that are on the market today.

A significant benefit of OLED displays over traditional liquid crystal displays (LCDs) is that OLEDs do not require a backlight to function. Thus these draw far less power and, when powered from a battery, can operate longer on the same charge. Because

there is no need for a backlight, an OLED display can be much thinner than an LCD panel.

At the moment, it's only Sony who has a commercial OLED panel in the market.

NEC Electronics, Renesas to merge operations

Japanese chipmakers NEC Electronics and Renesas Technology are negotiating to integrate their business operations by April 2010. If a deal is agreed, the combination would create the world's third largest semiconductor company. The duo plan to sign the merger agreement at the end of July this year. It is in light of fierce global competition in the semiconductor market that NEC Electronics and Renesas have agreed to explore the possibility of business integration in order to further strengthen their business foundations and technological assets.

The new integrated company will have three major product groups—microcontroller units, systems-on-chips and discrete products.

Toshiba sues Moser Baer India

Japanese electronics company Toshiba Corporation has filed a patent infringement suit in a US court against eight companies that manufacture and sell DVDs, including Moser Baer India. In its petition, Toshiba has sought an injunction on the use of its DVD patents by these companies.

Toshiba claims that these companies have been using a patented process to make the disks without a licence.

According to 'domain-b.com,' "Toshiba's petition has sought damages for past infringement and pleaded for court injunction on the sale, manufacture and import of recordable DVD media by the defendant companies named in the complaint. The products include recordable DVD media of the formats DVD-R, DVD+R, DVD-RW, DVD+RW, DVD+R DL, DVD-R DL and DVD-RAM."